

Guideline Title: Gastrointestinal Bleeding

Guideline Number: GUID-3203-M007

Issue date: 09/09/2014	Replaces Dept. Policy:
Revision dates: 6/8/2021	Developed by: Air Care Team
Approved by: Dr. Christopher Hunter, MD Air Care Team Medical Director	Approved by:
Signature: 	Signature:
Department Numbers: 3203	

- I. **PURPOSE:** To recognize the patient with gastrointestinal bleeding and to provide and maintain adequate oxygenation/ventilation and tissue perfusion. To provide expeditious transport to the nearest appropriate medical facility.
- II. **DEFINITIONS:** none
- III. **DEPARTMENT GUIDELINE:**
 - a. Establish care as defined by *GUID3203-G002 – General Patient Care*
 - b. Assess for signs of hypovolemia/shock, hypotension, tachycardia, decreased pulse pressure, angina, syncope, weakness, and confusion. “Coffee ground” emesis, hematemesis, or melena suggest a proximal lesion and hematochezia suggest a distal lesion.
 - c. Obtain history of medications (NSAIDs/aspirin), alcohol use, and anticoagulants
 - d. If signs of inadequate perfusion, treat per *GUID3203-M011 – Hypotension*
 - e. If emergency blood products are indicated, treat per *GUID3203-PR002 – Blood Product Administration*.
 - f. Consider naso-gastric tube (NG) placement if significant GI bleeding per *GUID3203-PR010 Gastric Tube Insertion*. Connect to low intermittent suction. Avoid over-vigorous suction to prevent mucosal trauma.
 - i. If patient has known or suspected esophageal varices, confirm with receiving physician prior to placing NG tube
 - g. If balloon tamponade (Minnesota or Blakemore tube) is in place, tracheal intubation should be placed and secured pre *GUID3203-PR020 – Endotracheal Intubation*.
 - h. Continue administration of the following:
 - i. **Pantoprazole 80 mg IV bolus** followed by **Pantoprazole infusion at 8 mg/hour**.
 - ii. **Octreotide 50 mcg IV bolus** followed by **Octreotide infusion at 50 mcg/h** for bleeding esophageal varices.
 - iii. **Vasopressin infusion 0.2-0.4 units/min** for refractory hypotension
 - i. Consider premedicating patient with **Zofran 4 mg IV** for nausea/vomiting and treating per *GUID3203-G004 – Nausea/Vomiting/Motion Sickness*.

Guideline Title: **Gastrointestinal Bleeding**

Guideline Number: **GUID-3203-M007**

IV. **DOCUMENTATION:** EMS Charts

V. **REFERENCES:**